Note

The moment of inertia of the same uniform rod is different about different axes of reference. The reference axes could be even outside the object. We have two useful theorems to calculate the moments of inertia about different axes. We shall see these theorems in Section 5.4.5.

5.4.2 Moment of Inertia of a Uniform Ring

Let us consider a uniform ring of mass M and radius R. To find the moment of inertia of the ring about an axis passing through its centre and perpendicular to the plane, let us take an infinitesimally small mass (dm) of length (dx) of the ring. This (dm) is located at a distance R, which is the radius of the ring from the axis as shown in Figure 5.22.

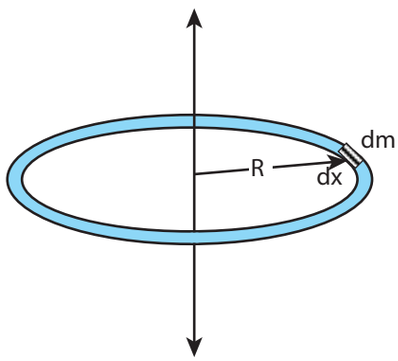


Figure 5.22 Moment of inertia of a uniform ring

The moment of inertia (dI) of this small mass (dm) is,

$$dI = (dm)R^2$$

The length of the ring is its circumference $(2\pi R)$. As the mass is uniformly distributed, the mass per unit length (λ) is,

$$\lambda = \frac{\text{mass}}{\text{length}} = \frac{M}{2\pi R}$$

The mass (dm) of the infinitesimally small length is, $dm = \lambda\, dx = \frac{M}{2\pi R} dx$

Now, the moment of inertia (I) of the entire ring is,

$$I = \int dI = \int (dm)R^2 = \int \left(\frac{M}{2\pi R} dx\right) R^2$$

$$I = \frac{MR}{2\pi} \int dx$$

To cover the entire length of the ring, the limits of integration are taken from 0 to $2\pi R$.

$$I = \frac{MR}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi R} dx$$

$$I = \frac{MR}{2\pi} [x]_0^{2\pi R} = \frac{MR}{2\pi} [2\pi R - 0]$$

$$I = MR^2 \qquad (5.42)$$

5.4.3 Moment of Inertia of a Uniform Disc

Consider a disc of mass M and radius R. This disc is made up of many infinitesimally small rings as shown in Figure 5.23. Consider one such ring of mass (dm) and thickness (dr) and radius (r). The moment of inertia (dI) of this small ring is,

$$dI = (dm)r^2$$

As the mass is uniformly distributed, the mass per unit area (σ) is, $\sigma = \frac{\text{mass}}{\text{area}} = \frac{M}{\pi R^2}$

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